PLANNING

BEFORE YOU GO: A CHECKLIST

MONTHS AHEAD

- ☐ Book lodges (13 months ahead, on the 5th of the month) or campsites (6 months ahead).
- ☐ Decide which entrance you will use, and check it opens on your dates (page 11).
- ☐ Buy an annual or America the Beautiful pass if you will visit both parks and others.
- ☐ Visitors from abroad: budget for the $100 nonresident fee per person 16+, unless you buy an annual pass.

THE WEEK BEFORE

- ☐ Check the park roads pages for construction delays and closures.
- ☐ Sign up for Yellowstone text alerts: text 82190 to 888-777.
- ☐ Scan the code on page 4 for changes since this book was printed.
- ☐ Download offline maps for both parks and the roads in between.

IN THE CAR

- ☐ Bear spray, one can per hiker, in a holster, not in the pack.
- ☐ Binoculars, and a long lens if you take photos of wildlife.
- ☐ Warm layers and rain gear.
- ☐ Water and food for the day: services are far apart.
- ☐ A full tank when you pass a gas station on a long day.
- ☐ This book, with a pencil for the updates.

EACH MORNING

- ☐ Check the day's road status before you set off.
- ☐ Note the predicted geyser times if you are heading to Old Faithful (posted at the visitor center).
- ☐ Plan to reach the busiest parking areas early.



Schwabacher Landing at sunrise, Chapter 17. Photo: Andrew Parlette from Elkridge,MD, US · CC BY 2.0